



MOST OF THE PEOPLE WHO LIVE ON THE WORLD'S biggest island GREENLANDERS

MODERN LIFE IN A FROZEN WORLD

(it's more than three times the size of Texas) are descended from Inuit groups and from

Proud land

Although it's part of Denmark, Greenland has had wide-ranging powers of self-rule since 1979. Elected every four years, the Greenlandic parliament, called the *Landsting*, oversees most domestic legislation, including the country's modern and efficient health, welfare, and education systems.



MIXED FEELINGS

On the first day of school, children wave their national flag—the flag of Denmark. Greenland is very dependent on Denmark: most of its money comes from the Danish government, which also runs its foreign affairs and legal system. Some people resent this, though, and want to be totally independent.

SUMMER CRAFT

Hunting is an important industry in Greenland. Some Inuits still catch seals, walruses, and small whales from traditional boats called kayaks. To make them light enough for one man to carry, these were originally covered with seal skin. Today, this has been replaced by plastic-coated canvas.



RELIABLE TRANSPORTATION

These strong huskie dogs are harnessed up to pull an old-fashioned sled. While snowmobiles are sometimes used to travel across icy terrain, they are not allowed in many places because the noise they make frightens animals and scares away game. For this reason, and because machines tend to break down and run out of fuel, traditional transportation is often the best.

RULES OF HUNTING

Federal law dictates which animals can be hunted with guns. Hunters, who are mainly Inuit (Greenlandic Inuit are called *Inughuit*) cannot shoot narwhal, for instance, but they can shoot *nanuq*, the great polar bear. There are also limits on the numbers that can be killed. Such legislation not only protects species, but it also acknowledges the Inuit view that animals have spirit owners who demand respect.



Polar bear pants.